

Primary Source Verification and Credentialing

Policy Number	POL-CMP-086	Owner / Department	Medical Staff Office / Human Resources
Effective Date	2024-03-01	Version	2.0
Last Revised	2026-05-05	Next Review	2028-05-05
Approved By	Medical Executive Committee	Applies To	All licensed independent practitioners, advanced practice providers, and licensed/certified staff requiring verification

1. Purpose

This policy establishes how Riverside Regional Medical Center verifies the qualifications of practitioners and licensed/certified staff through primary source verification (PSV) before they provide care, consistent with The Joint Commission MS/HR standards and the CMS Condition of Participation for the medical staff (42 CFR 482.22). It also defines ongoing expiration tracking so no one practices on a lapsed credential.

2. Definitions

- **Primary source verification (PSV)** — confirmation of a credential directly from the issuing source or an approved designated-agent equivalent, not from a copy supplied by the applicant.
- **Credentialing** — collecting and verifying qualifications (education, training, licensure, competence).
- **Privileging** — granting a practitioner specific clinical privileges based on verified competence.

3. Verification Sources

Credential	Primary source
State license	State licensing board (online verification or direct confirmation)
Board certification	The certifying board (e.g., ABMS member board)
Education / training	The medical/professional school and residency program
DEA registration	DEA registration verification
Sanctions / exclusions	NPDB query and OIG/SAM exclusion lists

4. Expiration Tracking

The Medical Staff Office and Human Resources maintain a tracked record of every time-limited credential. This directly supports the facility Employee Certification workflow, which tracks each certification by **hospital**, **certification type**, and **expiration date** so that upcoming lapses are surfaced before they occur.

- Reverify time-limited credentials (license, board certification, DEA, BLS/ACLS, and similar) at or before expiration.
- Generate expiration alerts well in advance so renewal is completed before the lapse date.

- Suspend privileges or assignment automatically when a required credential lapses.

IMPORTANT — No practitioner or certified staff member may provide care on an expired or unverified credential. If a lapse is discovered, suspend the affected privileges or assignment immediately and notify the Medical Staff Office, the department chair, and Compliance before the next scheduled shift.

5. Severity & Reporting

Credentialing failures are classified on the facility-wide scale in POL-RM-013. A lapse that allowed an unqualified or unverified provider to practice is a serious event: if a patient was harmed it is SEV-1 (notify the Administrator-on-Call, the Chief Medical Officer, and Compliance within 1 hour); if a patient was seen but not harmed it is SEV-2 (notify the Medical Staff Office and Compliance within 4 hours). A lapse caught by expiration tracking before any patient contact is a Near Miss (report within 24 hours).

6. References

- The Joint Commission MS and HR standards (credentialing and primary source verification).
- CMS Conditions of Participation, 42 CFR 482.22 (medical staff).
- National Practitioner Data Bank (NPDB); OIG/SAM exclusion databases.
- Related: POL-RM-013 (severity & reporting).